

Background Guide



Press Corps - TFS MUN

-By the Honourable Chair of the Press Corps

Arnav Singh

Press Corps: Background Guide

Letter from the EB:

It is our distinct honor to welcome you to the International Press Corps at TFS JMUN 2026. This is one of those UN committees where you hold the unique role of journalists, photojournalists, and editors representing global media houses. Your objective is not to pass resolutions, but to hold power accountable, report accurately on committee proceedings, and capture the narrative of the conference as it unfolds.

Be sure to read this background guide thoroughly to understand your news agency's stance, press and ethical guidelines. We look forward to seeing your sharp questions, compelling headlines, and impactful reporting!

Warm regards,

Arnav Singh

Chair, International Press Corps

TFS JMUN 2026

Introduction to Press Corps:

How the Press Corps Works in Model United Nations (MUN)

The Press Corps is one of the most unique committees in Model United Nations because, unlike delegates, its members are not diplomats. Instead, they become professional journalists whose responsibility is to observe, investigate, interview, and report everything happening during the conference. Think of it as a real newsroom operating alongside the MUN. While delegates negotiate resolutions and represent countries, Press Corps members represent the public's right to know. Their job is to document events accurately, explain complex debates to readers, and hold delegates accountable by asking challenging questions. In many conferences, the Press Corps is considered the "eyes and ears" of the entire event because it connects every committee through news coverage.

Before the Conference Begins

Before committee sessions start, Press Corps members are usually assigned either to a news agency (such as Reuters,

BBC, Al Jazeera, or The New York Times) or simply become independent conference journalists, depending on the conference's format. They receive press credentials, learn the conference rules, and understand what kind of content they are expected to produce. Some conferences expect only written articles, while others include photography, video journalism, podcasts, social media updates, or even live broadcasts. Members often research the committees beforehand so they understand the agendas and the background of major international issues. For example, if one committee is discussing climate change while another debates cyber warfare, the journalist studies these topics so they can ask informed questions instead of simply recording speeches.

Observing Committee Sessions

Most of a journalist's day is spent walking into committee rooms and carefully observing debates. Unlike delegates, journalists usually do not speak during formal debate unless they are given permission to conduct interviews. They sit quietly, taking extensive notes on everything that happens. They record who proposed important ideas, which countries formed alliances, which delegates gave persuasive speeches, what conflicts arose during negotiations, and whether any

surprising events occurred. Good journalists never rely on memory; they continuously write down names, quotes, committee actions, voting results, and timestamps. This attention to detail ensures that every article they later write is factually accurate.

The Press Corps also pays attention to the atmosphere of the room. Sometimes the most interesting story is not the resolution itself but the way delegates interact. For instance, a heated disagreement between two countries, an unexpected coalition between rivals, or an emotional speech defending human rights may become the headline of the day's news. Journalists are trained to identify what is genuinely newsworthy rather than simply repeating everything that happened.

Conducting Interviews

One of the most important parts of being in the Press Corps is interviewing delegates. After committee sessions or during breaks, journalists approach delegates and ask questions about their country's position, recent speeches, proposed resolutions, or controversial decisions. A journalist might ask:

- "Why did your delegation oppose the amendment?"**
- "How does your resolution address developing nations?"**

- **"What challenges have you faced during negotiations?"**
- **"Which countries are currently supporting your proposal?"**
- **"What compromises are you willing to make?"**

The goal is not merely to collect quotes but to understand the reasoning behind diplomatic decisions. Strong interviews often reveal information that never appeared during formal debate. Delegates may explain hidden negotiations, discuss alliances, or describe why certain compromises were necessary. These insights make articles more interesting and informative.

Guidelines for Delegates

- ***Accuracy:*** Fact-check before publishing.
- ***Professionalism:*** Respectful language, even in satire.
- ***Creativity:*** Blend serious journalism with humor.
- ***Deadlines:*** Submit articles promptly to ensure relevance.
- ***Balance:*** Avoid bias; satire should never cross into disrespect.

Types of Articles in the Press Corps:

The Press Corps produces a variety of articles to capture the spirit of the conference. Each format has its own purpose and style, ensuring coverage is both informative and engaging.

Beat-Based Journalism

Introduction

In professional journalism, a “beat” refers to a specific area of coverage assigned to a reporter — for example, politics, sports, or culture. In MUN Press Corps, beats help organize coverage so that every committee and major event gets consistent attention.

Key Features

- **Specialization:** Each reporter is assigned to a committee or theme (e.g., Security Council, Human Rights Council, or even “social events”).
- **Consistency:** The same reporter follows their beat throughout the conference, ensuring continuity and depth.

- **Neutrality:** Beat reports are factual, summarizing debates, resolutions, and key speeches without personal bias.
- **Structure:** Usually written in a news-report style — headline, lead paragraph, body with details, and conclusion.

Example (Beat Report)

Headline: “Security Council Divided Over Middle East Crisis”

Lead: The Security Council spent its second session debating intervention strategies in the Middle East, with sharp disagreements between the US and Russia.

Body: Delegates from France and China emphasized humanitarian aid, while others pushed for military involvement. The debate remains unresolved as the committee prepares for a draft resolution.

Opinion Editorials (Op-Eds)

Introduction

Op-eds (short for “opposite the editorial page”) are opinion pieces written by journalists to express a perspective on current events. In MUN, op-eds allow Press Corps delegates

to analyze debates, critique strategies, or highlight broader themes with their own voice.

Key Features

- **Subjectivity:** Unlike beat reports, op-eds are opinion-driven. The writer takes a stance.
- **Persuasion:** The goal is to convince readers of a viewpoint, often using rhetorical devices.
- **Creativity:** Writers can use humor, satire, or sharp analysis to make their point.
- **Structure:** Typically begins with a strong hook, develops an argument with evidence, and ends with a memorable conclusion.

Example (Op-Ed)

Title: “The Art of Saying Nothing: A Delegate’s Guide”

Intro: If speeches were measured by word count alone, yesterday’s General Assembly would have been a resounding success. Unfortunately, substance was in short supply.

Argument: Delegates repeated slogans without offering concrete solutions. This reflects a larger issue in diplomacy — the tendency to prioritize appearances over action.

Conclusion: Unless delegates move beyond rhetoric, the resolutions will remain as empty as the speeches that birthed them.

Why Both Matter in MUN

- **Beat Reports give delegates factual updates and ensure transparency.**

Op-Eds spark debate, entertain, and challenge delegates to think critically.

- **Together, they balance neutral reporting with creative commentary, making your Press Corps dynamic and engaging.**

Photography in the Press Corps

Why Photography Matters

Photography captures the *spirit* of the conference — the energy of debate, the candid moments in lobbying, and the atmosphere of diplomacy. It adds depth to coverage and makes the Press Corps' work more engaging.

How to Create a Photo Essay

1. Plan Your Story

- **Decide on a theme (e.g., “Day in Committee,” “Behind the Scenes,” “Delegates in Action”).**
- **Think of a beginning, middle, and end — just like a written article.**

2. Capture Key Moments

- **Formal: speeches, voting, moderated caucuses.**
- **Informal: lobbying, laughter, candid delegate interactions.**
- **Symbolic: placards raised, gavel strikes, handshakes.**

3. Sequence Your Photos

- **Arrange images in logical order to show progression.**

- **Example:** *Opening Ceremony → Debate in Action → Networking Break.*

4. Write Captions

- **Keep them short (1–2 sentences).**
- **Provide context, add humor, or highlight significance.**
- **Example:** “*Delegates passionately debate climate policy — but the coffee table remains the busiest spot.*”

5. Balance Creativity with Respect

- **Avoid intrusive or unflattering shots.**
- **Ensure photos enhance the story, not distract from it.**

Quick Tips

- **Always carry your camera/phone ready.**
- **Use natural light when possible.**
- **Capture emotions — smiles, intensity, concentration.**
- **Think like a storyteller, not just a photographer.**

Reference links

Here are some links to assist and guide you:

Article Writing:

- **[Beat reporting - Wikipedia](#)**
- <https://www.bing.com/ck/a?!&&p=a30ea39eabd9503d0531957ca2e3f54b5a6577c3a868e25e244d74550bea0ec6JmItldHM9MTc4NTE5NjgwMA&ptn=3&ver=2&hsh=4&fclid=3e54017d-9838-66a7-2a2d-16ef996d67dd&psq=beat+based+articles&u=a1aHR0cHM6Ly93d3cuaGVkdW5hLmNvbS9oZWlucmljaC1vc3dhdGQvY2hhcHRlci00LWNyYWZ0aW5nLWJlYXQtYmFzZWQtYXJ0aWNsZXM>
- <https://www.bing.com/ck/a?!&&p=eeebc7deafbbc56bc5fa66fe1529aa1e2a174722455c76c9bf23ab303480da89JmItldHM9MTc4NTE5NjgwMA&ptn=3&ver=2&hsh=4&fclid=3e54017d-9838-66a7-2a2d-16ef996d67dd&psq=op+ed+articles+mun+links&u=a1aHR0cHM6Ly9ibG9nLm1vZGVsZGlwbG9tYXQuY29tL3dpbm5pbmctZXhhbXBsZXMTcG9zaXRpb24tcGFwZXJzLW11bi0yMDI2>
- <https://www.bing.com/ck/a?!&&p=d23ab26a66715248094e9698caeb885d19c5778c6e9cd85c849fdaed02bea77cJmItldHM9MTc4NTE5NjgwMA&ptn=3&ver=2&hsh=4&fclid=3e54017d-9838-66a7-2a2d-16ef996d67dd&psq=op+ed+articles+mun+links&u=a1aHR0cHM6Ly93d3cuZGVsaGltdW4uaW4vZGVsZWdhdGUtcmlvZ3VyY2VzL211bi1pbnRlcm5hdGlvbmlFsLXByZXNzLWd1aWRl>
- **[Photojournalism:](#)**
<https://www.bing.com/ck/a?!&&p=b886af0fb974bbe039315476e8604a9f71beba61bb6bf1964d82982897c89a84JmItldHM9MTc4NTE5NjgwMA&ptn=3&ver=2&hsh=4&fclid=3e54017d-9838-66a7-2a2d-16ef996d67dd&psq=photography+mun&u=a1aHR0cHM6Ly9tdW4uc3VjaGl0cmEuaW4vd3AtY29udGVudC91cGxvYWRzLzlwMjUvMDcvSVAtUEhPVEdSQVBIWS1CQUNLR1JPVU5ELUdVSURFLU1VUjJlcucGRm>

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Article Types Recap

- **Beat Reports → Neutral, factual coverage of committees.**
- **Op-Eds → Opinion-driven, persuasive, often witty.**
- **Interviews → Delegate perspectives, Q&A format.**
- **Satire Columns → Entertaining commentary with respect.**
- **Photo Essays → Visual storytelling with captions.**

Writing Checklist

- **Beat Report → Who, What, When, Where, Why.**
- **Op-Ed → Clear stance + evidence + persuasive tone.**
- **Interview → Prepare questions + capture quotes.**
- **Satire → Humor + critique, but respectful.**
- **Photo Essay → Sequence of images + captions.**

Final Note

All the best to every delegate stepping into the Press Corps this MUN. With creativity, clarity, and critical thinking, the Press Corps will not only excel but truly capture the spirit of diplomacy. I am confident the Press Corps will shine this year and set a new benchmark for excellence.